

FM

MBA · meerut university
Based on 4 year(s) of previous papers

Topic Priority Overview

Topic	Priority	Confidence	Freq	Marks
Definition and Importance of Management	High	High	4×	15-22.5 marks
Decision Making: elements & process	High	High	4×	15-22.5 marks
Delegation of Authority: necessity & factors	High	High	3×	15-22.5 marks
Delegation vs Decentralisation (difference/ comparison)	Medium	Medium	2×	7.5-15 marks
Control: concept, importance, process & types	High	High	4×	15-22.5 marks
Planning: objectives & process	High	High	3×	7.5-15 marks
Motivation: definition, nature & different styles	High	High	3×	7.5-15 marks
Leadership: traits and 'Are leaders born?' / Leadership styles	Medium	Medium	2×	3-7.5 marks
Organisation: definition, forms and types (including line-organization)	High	High	3×	15-22.5 marks
Authority vs Responsibility (parity between authority & responsibility)	High	High	3×	7.5-22.5 marks
Communication: definition, types & characteristics (including formal communication)	High	High	4×	3-15 marks
Span of Control	Low	Low	1×	3 marks
Supervision: meaning and short explanation	Low	Low	1×	7.5-15 marks
Unity of Command (principle)	Low	Low	1×	7.5 marks
Departmentation: definition & principle	Low	Low	1×	7.5 marks
Directing: concepts, principles & techniques	Medium	Medium	2×	15-22.5 marks
Controlling: principles (specific)	Medium	Medium	2×	15-22.5 marks
Centralisation vs Decentralisation (distinguish)	Medium	Medium	2×	7.5-15 marks
Coordination: definition and role	Low	Low	1×	3 marks

Line Organization: definition & features	Low	Low	1×	3 marks
Process vs Elements Distinction Questions (Administration vs Management)	Low	Low	1×	7.5 marks
Characteristics of Good Communication (explicit)	Medium	Medium	2×	15-22.5 marks
Planning Objectives vs Planning Process distinction	Low	Low	1×	7.5-15 marks

Detailed Study Notes

Read these notes carefully — they're based on actual patterns found in your past papers.

1. Definition and Importance of Management

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 3 · Paper 4 · 4× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 short answers across papers | Long: 2-3 long essays

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Exact definition of 'management' as asked in long questions (e.g. "What do you understand by management?")
- Nature/characteristics of management (list elements used in paper phrasing)
- Reasons/importance for increasing role of management in modern age (Paper 1 phrasing)
- Distinguish 'Administration and Management' where asked (Paper 1 Section-B Q6)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Direct definitional long-essay: "What is management? Explain the nature and significance" or short explain-type: "What is management?"

Repeat Pattern:

Har saal ayega — definition + nature + importance ek combined long question form multiple years mein consistently.

Key Terms:

management definition

nature of management

importance

administration vs management

2. Decision Making: elements & process

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 3 · Paper 4 · 4× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 short answers | Long: 2-4 long essays

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Elements of decision making (Paper 1 phrase: "main elements of decision making")
- Steps/process of decision making as listed in papers (Paper 2 & 3: "process of Decision-making")
- Explain decision making as a management function (Paper 1: "decision making process")
- Applied phrasing: "Management is always a decision making process" — how to justify with elements

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Often as a long essay: "Explain and discuss the main elements of decision making" or "Describe the process of decision-making"; sometimes used in short-answer 7.5-mark format.

Repeat Pattern:

Exactly repeated every year — same wording: 'process' or 'elements' of decision making appear across all papers.

Key Terms:

elements of decision making

decision-making process

steps

management decision

3. Delegation of Authority: necessity & factors

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 4 · 3× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 short answers | Long: 1-3 long essays

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Definition and meaning of 'delegation of authority' (Paper 4 short Q2)
- Why delegation is necessary (Paper 1: "Why it is necessary?")
- Factors to be kept in mind while delegation (Paper 1: "What factors should be kept in mind while delegation?")
- Difference between delegation and decentralisation (Paper 2/1 phrasing: "difference between delegation and decentralisation")

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Direct question: "What do you mean by delegation of authority? Why it is necessary? What factors..." or 7.5/15-mark compare-style between delegation and decentralisation.

Repeat Pattern:

Appears multiple years mainly as a direct definition + necessity + factors question and once as difference vs decentralisation.

Key Terms:

delegation definition

necessity

factors in delegation

delegation vs decentralisation

4. Control: concept, importance, process & types

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 3 · Paper 4 · 4× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 short answers | Long: 2-4 long essays

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Definition of control and concept (Paper 1 Q12: "What do you understand by control?")
- Importance of control in business management (Paper 1 wording)
- Process of controlling (Paper 2/3 phrasing: "process of controlling")
- Types of control/various types and principles of controlling (Paper 3 & Paper 4: "various types of control"; "principles of controlling")

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Long essay style: "What do you understand by control? Discuss its importance" or process + types as separate long answers.

Repeat Pattern:

Control-related long questions are present every year in similar wording: concept, process, types, importance/principles.

Key Terms:

control definition

types of control

process of controlling

principles of controlling

5. Planning: objectives & process

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 3 · 3× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 short answers | Long: 1-2 long essays

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Process of planning (Paper 1 Q7: "Explain the process of planning")
- Objectives of planning (Paper 3: "What are the objectives of planning?")
- Relationship between planning and controlling (Paper 2 Q8: "Explain the relationship between planning and controlling?")
- 'Planning is looking ahead' phrasing and explanation (Paper 2/3 style quotes)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Asked as process explanation, objectives listing, or relational explanation (planning vs controlling). Usually 7.5-15 mark format.

Repeat Pattern:

Appears repeatedly as process/objectives and relationship with control; strong repeatability over years.

Key Terms:

planning process

objectives of planning

planning vs controlling

planning steps

6. Motivation: definition, nature & different styles

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 3 · Paper 4 · 3× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 short answers | Long: 1-3 long essays

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Definition of Motivation (Paper 1 & Paper 4 wording)
- Nature/characteristics of motivation (Paper 1: "Discuss its nature")
- Different styles of motivation (Paper 1: "different styles")
- Importance of motivation (Paper 3 & Paper 4: "Discuss the importance of motivation")

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Asked as either short definition + importance or a long question that requires listing nature and styles; often in Section-C long-answer.

Repeat Pattern:

Motivation as both definition and theory question recurs almost every year; styles + nature appear specifically in Paper 1.

Key Terms:

motivation definition

nature of motivation

styles of motivation

importance of motivation

7. Organisation: definition, forms and types (including line-organization)

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · Paper 3 · Paper 4 · 3× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 short answers | Long: 1-2 long essays

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Definition of Organisation (Paper 2 Q10 phrasing)
- Different types/forms of organisation (Paper 2 & Paper 4: "Explain different types of organisation" / "Discuss various forms of organisation")
- Line-organization: definition and features (Paper 2: "What do you understand by Line-organization?")
- Organisation structure types and elements (Paper 3: "What do you mean by organization structure? Discuss the types of it.")

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Asked as either short or long: define organisation and then explain types/forms or structure; line-organization sometimes appears as a separate 3-mark item.

Repeat Pattern:

Organisation and its types are repeatedly tested as an independent long/short question in multiple years.

Key Terms:

organisation definition

forms of organisation

line organization

organisation structure types

8. Authority vs Responsibility (parity between authority & responsibility)

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 3 · Paper 4 · Paper 1 · 3× total

Question types: Short: 1-2 short answers | Long: 1-2 long essays

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Difference between authority and responsibility (Paper 3 Q7 phrasing)
- Concept of parity between authority and responsibility and explanation (Paper 4 and Paper 3 wording: "There should be parity between authority and responsibility")
- Examples or organisational implications when parity is/n't maintained (expected from the wording)
- Relation with delegation and decentralisation (papers that pair these topics)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Short to long explain-type question: either ask to 'Discuss the difference' or to 'Explain parity between authority and responsibility.'

Repeat Pattern:

Appears repeatedly, sometimes as a principle/explain question; consistent phrasing across papers.

Key Terms:

authority vs responsibility

parity between authority and responsibility

delegation relation

organisational balance

9. Communication: definition, types & characteristics (including formal communication)

High Conf.

High Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · Paper 3 · Paper 4 · 4× total

Question types: Short: 2-4 short answers | Long: 0-1 long essay

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Definition of communication (Paper 2/3 phrasing: "What is communication?")
- Types of communication including formal communication (Paper 1 Q4: "What is formal communication?" and Paper 3: "What is formal communication?")
- Characteristics of good communication (Paper 4: "Explain the characteristics of a good communication")
- Brief differences or examples used when asked (papers expect listing types/characteristics concisely)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Mostly very-short 3-mark questions asking definition or types; occasionally a 15/22.5-mark question on characteristics or explanation.

Repeat Pattern:

Communication definitions and types are present every year; formal communication specifically appears in Paper 1.

Key Terms:

formal communication

types of communication

characteristics

definition

10. Delegation vs Decentralisation (difference/ comparison)

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · Paper 3 · 2× total

Question types: Short: 1 short answer | Long: 1 long/compare answer

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Explicit differences listed when asked (Paper 2: "Write the difference between delegation and decentralisation")
- Definitions of centralisation and decentralisation to compare (Paper 2 Q6)
- Practical indicators/organizational effects used in past questions (how decentralisation affects authority/responsibility)
- Comparative points: control, speed of decision, authority transfer (as expected by paper phrasing)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Compare/contrast short or long question: "Write the difference between delegation and decentralisation" or "Distinguish between centralisation and decentralisation."

Repeat Pattern:

Seen in 2 years as a clear compare question — expect similar compare wording when it appears.

Key Terms:

delegation vs decentralisation

centralisation

differences

authority distribution

11. Leadership: traits and 'Are leaders born?' / Leadership styles

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · Paper 2 · 2× total

Question types: Short: 2 very short answers

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Short answer on 'Are leaders born? Explain.' (Paper 1 phrasing)
- Definition and identification of leadership style (Paper 2: "What do you mean by Leadership style?")
- Be ready to name common leadership styles (since paper asks "Leadership style" directly)
- One-sentence trait-based answers or short explanations as per very-short format

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Usually as a 3-mark very short answer: asking opinion/definition: 'Are leaders born? Explain' or 'What is leadership style?'.

Repeat Pattern:

Seen twice as short-answer items; expect short definitional or opinion-type prompts rather than essays.

Key Terms:

leadership traits

leadership style

born vs made

short explanation

12. Directing: concepts, principles & techniques

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 3 · Paper 4 · 2× total

Question types: Short: 1 short answer | Long: 1-2 long essays

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Concept/definition of directing as a management function
- Key principles of directing (e.g., clarity of instructions, unity of command as related, direct supervision, motivation and leadership techniques)
- Techniques of directing (supervision, motivation, leadership, communication) with short examples
- Distinguish directing from related activities like supervision and control in brief

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Long descriptive question asking for concept, principles and techniques in detail or a short 7.5-mark meaning-type; expect to list principles and techniques with brief explanation.

Repeat Pattern:

Appeared in Paper 3 and Paper 4 as a substantive explanation-type question; typical wording: 'Discuss concept, principles & techniques of directing.'

Key Terms:

directing concept

principles of directing

techniques of directing

supervision linkage

13. Controlling: principles (specific)

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 3 · Paper 4 · 2× total

Question types: Long: 1-2 long essays

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Definition of controlling (Paper 4 Q13 phrasing)
- Principles of controlling specifically requested (Paper 4: "Explain the principles of controlling")
- How principles differ from types/process (papers separate these subtopics)
- Examples of applying principles in business (brief supporting points expected)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Asked as a long answer: 'Define controlling. Explain the principles of controlling.' — requires listing principles and short explanation.

Repeat Pattern:

Principles-of-controlling wording shown in Paper 4 and types/process appear elsewhere; expect principle-specific question occasionally.

Key Terms:

controlling principles

definition of controlling

application

control standards

14. Centralisation vs Decentralisation (distinguish)

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · Paper 1 · 2× total

Question types: Short: 1 short/medium answer | Long: 1 long compare answer

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Clear definitions of centralisation and decentralisation (Paper 2 Q6)
- Distinguishing features and organisational impacts (expected in 'Distinguish between' format)
- Relation to delegation and authority distribution (Paper 1/2 pairing)
- When centralisation is preferred vs decentralisation (short application points)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Compare/contrast question: 'Distinguish between centralisation and Decentralisation.' Usually 7.5 marks.

Repeat Pattern:

Seen twice in similar compare format; moderate repeatability.

Key Terms:

centralisation

decentralisation

differences

authority dispersion

15. Characteristics of Good Communication (explicit)

Medium Conf.

Medium Priority

Appeared in: Paper 4 · Paper 3 · 2× total

Question types: Short: 1 short answer | Long: 1-2 long essays

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Characteristics of good communication as requested explicitly (Paper 4: "Explain the characteristics of a good communication")
- Types of communication and how characteristics apply to each (Paper 3: types + characteristics link)
- Short examples demonstrating characteristics like clarity, accuracy, timeliness
- Relation to barriers briefly if asked within the same answer

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Often a medium-long question asking to 'Explain the characteristics of a good communication.' Expect listing plus short elaboration.

Repeat Pattern:

Seen in Papers 3 and 4; moderate chance of repeat.

Key Terms:

characteristics of communication

clarity

timeliness

accuracy

16. Span of Control

Low Conf.

Low Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · 1× total

Question types: Short: 1 short answer

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Definition of 'span of control' as a management term (Paper 1 Q5)
- Factors affecting span of control (short expected bullet points)
- Advantages and disadvantages when span is wide vs narrow (brief expected answer)
- Relation with delegation and supervision (as linked concepts in papers)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Very-short 3-mark question: direct definition style: 'What is span of control?'

Repeat Pattern:

Seen only once in Paper 1 as a 3-mark item — low repeat likelihood.

17. Supervision: meaning and short explanation

Low Conf.

Low Priority

Appeared in: Paper 4 · 1× total

Question types: Short: 1 short/medium answer

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Meaning/definition of supervision (Paper 4 Q1)
- Core roles and simple functions of a supervisor expected in a concise answer
- Distinguish supervision from directing in one or two lines if relevant
- Link with span of control and delegation briefly (common short-answer follow-ups)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Short 7.5-mark item in Section A (Paper 4 asked any two questions of 7.5 marks) so answer must be concise (<=75 words) and to the point.

Repeat Pattern:

Appeared once as a very-short item; prepare a crisp definition + 2-3 role bullets.

18. Unity of Command (principle)

Low Conf.

Low Priority

Appeared in: Paper 4 · 1× total

Question types: Short: 1 short answer

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Definition of the principle of unity of command (Paper 4 Q3)
- One or two illustrative points explaining the principle
- Contrast with multiple-command situations (expected short example)
- How unity of command affects organisation functioning (brief implication)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Short-answer 7.5-mark item: definitional/principle explanation not exceeding 75 words.

Repeat Pattern:

Appeared only in Paper 4 in the short section; low repeat frequency.

19. Departmentation: definition & principle

Low Conf.

Low Priority

Appeared in: Paper 4 · 1× total

Question types: Short: 1 short answer

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Definition of departmentation (Paper 4 Q4: "Define the principle of Departmentation")
- Common bases of departmentation (by function, product, territory) expected as short bullets
- Advantages of departmentation (1-2 short points)
- Relation with organisation structure types (brief linkage)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Very-short 7.5-mark question asking principle/definition and brief explanation.

Repeat Pattern:

Only explicit in Paper 4; likely occasional short-asked item.

20. Coordination: definition and role

Low Conf.

Low Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · 1× total

Question types: Short: 1 very-short answer

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Definition of 'co-ordination' as asked in Paper 2 Q1
- Brief functions/role of coordination in management (one-liner bullets)
- Distinguish coordination from communication where needed
- Examples of coordination mechanisms (short expected points)

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Very-short 3-mark definition question: 'What is co-ordination?'.

Repeat Pattern:

Appeared once as a very-short question — limited repeat evidence.

21. Line Organization: definition & features

Low Conf.

Low Priority

Appeared in: Paper 2 · 1× total

Question types: Short: 1 very-short answer

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Definition of line-organization (Paper 2 Q4)
- Main features/characteristics of line organization (short bullets)
- Advantages/disadvantages briefly if asked
- Distinguish line from staff or functional structures in one line

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Very-short 3-mark item asking 'What do you understand by Line-organization?'.

Repeat Pattern:

Only once as a short item; not strongly recurring.

22. Process vs Elements Distinction Questions (Administration vs Management)

Low Conf.

Low Priority

Appeared in: Paper 1 · 1× total

Question types: Short: 1 short answer

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Specific differences asked: 'Explain the difference between Administration and Management' (Paper 1 Q6)
- Points commonly expected: scope, functions, level, authority
- One-line comparative bullets linking administration to policy and management to execution
- Examples to illustrate difference briefly

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Short 7.5-mark compare/contrast format asking direct differences.

Repeat Pattern:

Seen in Paper 1 as a short compare question; occasional but not frequent.

23. Planning Objectives vs Planning Process

Low Conf.

Low Priority

distinction

Appeared in: Paper 3 · 1× total

Question types: Short: 1 short answer

Kya Padhna Hai:

- Objectives of planning explicitly (Paper 3 Q8: "What are the objectives of planning?")
- How objectives differ from the steps/process of planning (papers treat them separately)
- Key bullets for common objectives: direction, efficiency, risk reduction (expected terms)
- Brief description of the planning process when asked in same question

Kaise Poochha Jaata Hai:

Short-answer format requiring listing objectives and occasionally process elements.

Repeat Pattern:

Explicit objectives question appears in Paper 3; related process questions appear elsewhere.

Related Topic Pairs

Yeh topics exam mein aksar ek saath poochhe jaate hain — inhe milake padho.

1. Delegation of Authority <-> Delegation vs Decentralisation: papers often ask direct difference or relate delegation needs to decentralisation (Paper 1 & Paper 2).

2. Planning: process & Controlling: process/types — appear in same discussions about 'planning is looking ahead and controlling is looking back' (Paper 2, Paper 3).

3. Authority vs Responsibility <-> Parity between Authority and Responsibility: Paper 3 & Paper 4 ask both the difference and parity — students should prepare these together.

4. Communication: types & Characteristics of Good Communication — Paper 3 & Paper 4 test types and characteristics closely, so prepare as a pair.

Apni Strategy Chuno

Pick your goal — here's exactly which topics to study based on past paper patterns.

□ *Bas Pass Hona Hai*

Just want to pass — 9 of 23 topics · ~61% marks coverage

1. Definition and Importance of Management
2. Decision Making: elements & process
3. Control: concept, importance, process & types
4. Communication: definition, types & characteristics (including formal communication)
5. Delegation of Authority: necessity & factors
6. Planning: objectives & process
7. Motivation: definition, nature & different styles
8. Organisation: definition, forms and types (including line-organization)
9. Authority vs Responsibility (parity between authority & responsibility)

□ *Average Score Chahiye*

Decent score — 15 of 23 topics · ~84% marks coverage

1. Definition and Importance of Management
2. Decision Making: elements & process
3. Control: concept, importance, process & types
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5. Delegation of Authority: necessity & factors
6. Planning: objectives & process
7. Motivation: definition, nature & different styles
8. Organisation: definition, forms and types (including line-organization)
9. Authority vs Responsibility (parity between authority & responsibility)
10. Delegation vs Decentralisation (difference/comparison)
11. Leadership: traits and 'Are leaders born?' / Leadership styles
12. Directing: concepts, principles & techniques
13. Controlling: principles (specific)
14. Centralisation vs Decentralisation (distinguish)
15. Characteristics of Good Communication (explicit)

▣ Top Karna Hai

Full coverage — all 23 topics · 100% marks coverage

1. Definition and Importance of Management
2. Decision Making: elements & process
3. Control: concept, importance, process & types
4. Communication: definition, types & characteristics (including formal communication)
5. Delegation of Authority: necessity & factors
6. Planning: objectives & process
7. Motivation: definition, nature & different styles
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15. Characteristics of Good Communication (explicit)
16. Span of Control
17. Supervision: meaning and short explanation
18. Unity of Command (principle)
19. Departmentation: definition & principle
20. Coordination: definition and role
21. Line Organization: definition & features
22. Process vs Elements Distinction Questions (Administration vs Management)
23. Planning Objectives vs Planning Process distinction

Overall Exam Strategy

Bas Pass Hona Hai: focus first on exact definitions and 4 stepwise processes (decision-making, planning, controlling, delegation factors). These map directly to the 15/22.5-mark questions that recur; concise memorised bullets for Maslow, types of control, communication types and organisation types cover most short-answer items.